



MGC Freight - BRD

Business Requirement Document

Project Title: Freight Booking Platform

1. Introduction

The purpose of this document is to outline the business requirements for the development of the Freight Booking Platform, which is designed to streamline and enhance the shipping processes for businesses by offering comprehensive functionalities for booking, tracking, and managing shipments through integration with major carriers.

2. Project Overview

The platform aims to provide an integrated, scalable solution for shipping management by leveraging APIs from carriers such as FedEx, USPS, UPS, and others, offering real-time shipping rate comparisons, booking, tracking, invoicing, and claims management from a single interface.

3. Objectives and Scope

Objectives

- Develop a user-friendly, scalable web application that simplifies the end-to-end shipping process.
- Integrate multiple carrier APIs to provide real-time data and services.

- Implement comprehensive shipping management tools including quotations, bookings, tracking, invoicing, and claims.
- Implement secure payment methods and processing.

Scope

- **Customer Onboarding:** Facilitate user registration, login, and profile management.
 - **Quotations Module:** Users input shipment details to receive real-time quotes.
 - **Booking and Rates Display Module:** Book shipments and manage previous bookings.
 - **Shipment Tracking Module:** Provides real-time tracking updates. (Internal and carrier tracking)
 - **Invoices Dashboard Module:** Manage invoices and payments.
 - **Claims Management Module:** Submission and tracking of claims.
 - **Admin Management Dashboard:** Comprehensive tools for platform management.
 - **Payments:** All payment data will be securely encrypted and stored, complying with PCI DSS standards for security.
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4. Stakeholders

- **Project Sponsor:**
 - **Project Manager:** Shahzad
 - **Business Analyst:** Omar
 - **Development Team:**
 - **Quality Assurance Team:**
 - **End Users:**
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5. Functional Requirements

Customer Platform

- **User Registration/Login:** Secure sign-up/log-in processes with email verification.
- **Dashboard:** Customizable overview of shipping operations with KPIs, real-time notifications, and alerts (All, Urgent, New, Today, Tomorrow).
- **Shipping Quotations:** Forms for entering shipment specifics and retrieving instant carrier rates, with manual rate input for offline carriers.
- **Shipment Booking and Tracking:** Tools for scheduling shipments and tracking their progress. This module allows manual entry of shipment details for carriers not integrated via APIs.
- **Invoicing:** Generation of invoices based on shipping details, with options for online payment including PayPal, Stripe, and Discover.
- **Claims Management:** Submission forms for claims related to lost or damaged goods, with tracking functionality for claim status.
- **Notifications/Reminders:** List and management of notifications and reminders with options to view, mark, and manage based on date, time, title, and message. (email or in platform)
- **Search and Filters:** Extensive search and filtering options across the platform for shipments, pickups, invoices, and claims.
- **Support and Tickets:** Tools for reporting issues and managing support tickets.
- **Payment Functionality:** Transactions will be processed using integrated payment processors such as Stripe or other systems suggested by the client. The platform will accept payments via credit cards, PayPal, and other online methods (CC/NET 30 DAYS CHECK/EMAIL TRANSFER/FACTORING). (Carrier: SQUARE UP, Stripe).

Admin Dashboard

- **User Management:** Tools to add, remove, or modify user accounts/carriers.
- **Carrier Integration Settings:** Manage API settings and carrier integration details, including configuration for offline carriers.

- **Reporting and Analytics:** Comprehensive reporting tools for monitoring system usage, user activity, and financial metrics.
 - **Manual Entry Tools:** Admin tools for manually managing data entries and adjustments when carriers are offline or not integrated through APIs.
 - **Carrier Payments and Invoices:** To generate and manage detailed invoices for carriers that outline the breakdown of charges between the company and each carrier. This functionality includes automated generation of invoices based on contracted rates and actual shipment data, as well as the ability to manually create or adjust invoices as needed.
 - **Payment Verification and Approvals:** Functionality to view and approve payment methods and statuses, including checks and other forms of payment. Administrators can verify whether payments have cleared and approve shipment releases based on payment statuses.
 - **Support/Claims:** Managing user issues and support tickets. This includes features for categorizing tickets, prioritizing them based on urgency, and tracking their status through resolution. Automated responses for common queries and a dashboard for viewing all support metrics to ensure efficient customer service operations.
 - **Roles and Permissions:** Administrators can create and define custom roles based on operational needs, assigning specific permissions that control access to various functionalities within the platform.
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6. Non-Functional Requirements

- **Security:** Data encryption, secure API integrations, and compliance with data protection regulations.
 - **Performance:** System responsiveness under heavy load, capable of handling a significant number of concurrent users.
 - **Usability:** Intuitive UI/UX across various devices and platforms.
 - **Scalability:** Designed to accommodate growth in user base and data volume without degradation of performance.
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7. Assumptions

- Stable and reliable access to carrier APIs.
 - Sufficient project timeline and budget to meet the defined scope.
 - Availability of technical and human resources to support project demands.
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8. Constraints

- Adherence to the predefined project timeline of 3.5 months.
 - Budget constraints as specified in initial project agreements.
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9. Dependencies

- Reliance on external carrier APIs for real-time data.
 - Need for robust hosting solutions to support scalability and performance.
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10. Glossary

- **API:** Application Programming Interface
 - **CRUD:** Create, Read, Update, Delete
 - **UI/UX:** User Interface / User Experience
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11. Roles and Functionality

- **Admins:** Oversee platform operations, manage user roles and permissions, monitor system performance, and handle configurations.
 - **Business Users:** Access and utilize the platform for their shipping needs, manage shipments, track them, and handle related financial transactions.
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12. API Integration and Payment Gateway Confirmation

- **API Integration:** The client needs to confirm which carrier APIs are to be integrated for real-time data functionality, including any specific requirements.

- **Payment Gateways:** Confirmation from the client on the choice of payment gateways is essential. This includes deciding between options such as Stripe, PayPal, or other payment processors suggested by the client. Detailed specifications and requirements for each selected payment system need to be documented to ensure seamless integration and security compliance.